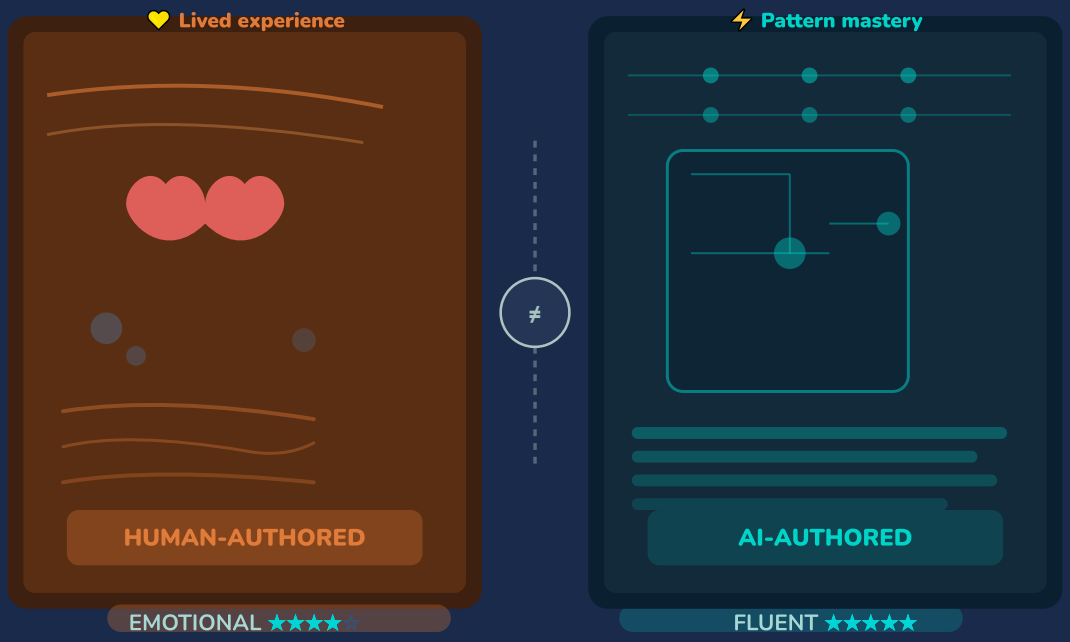
CAN AI TELL A STORY?

Can a machine create something that moves you?



READ

FEEL

COMPARE

CAN AI TELL A STORY?

Narrative is one of the most human things we do. This card explores whether AI-generated stories can achieve emotional authenticity — and what authenticity even means. Expect genuinely divided responses.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Read aloud two short stories (~200 words each) on the same theme: one written by a student or local author, one generated by AI. Do not reveal which is which.
2. After each: ask students to rate it 1–5 on emotional impact, originality, and realness. Collect ratings anonymously via slips.
3. Reveal the sources. Compare ratings. Were the results surprising? Did knowing the source change anyone's view?
4. Panel discussion: 5 students argue "AI can tell meaningful stories." 5 argue against. The rest vote after hearing both sides.

MATERIALS

- Printed story pair (theme: loss, joy, or belonging)
- Anonymous rating slips (1–5 scale)
- Panel name cards (5 per side)
- Tally board for class vote
- Discussion guide: what is emotional truth?

REFLECTION

- What makes a story feel real to you?
- Does knowing the source change how you feel about a story?
- Is there value in a story that no one lived through?
- Can AI be a co-author with a human?

REALITY CHECK

AI produces statistically likely language sequences.

It has not experienced loss, joy, fear, or love. Whether that matters for storytelling is one of the most interesting open questions in aesthetics. Some great literature is also imagined rather than lived.

GO DEEPER

Theatre Machine

Scan to play →

⏱ 55 MIN | PANEL DISCUSSION | ADVANCED | CARD 20